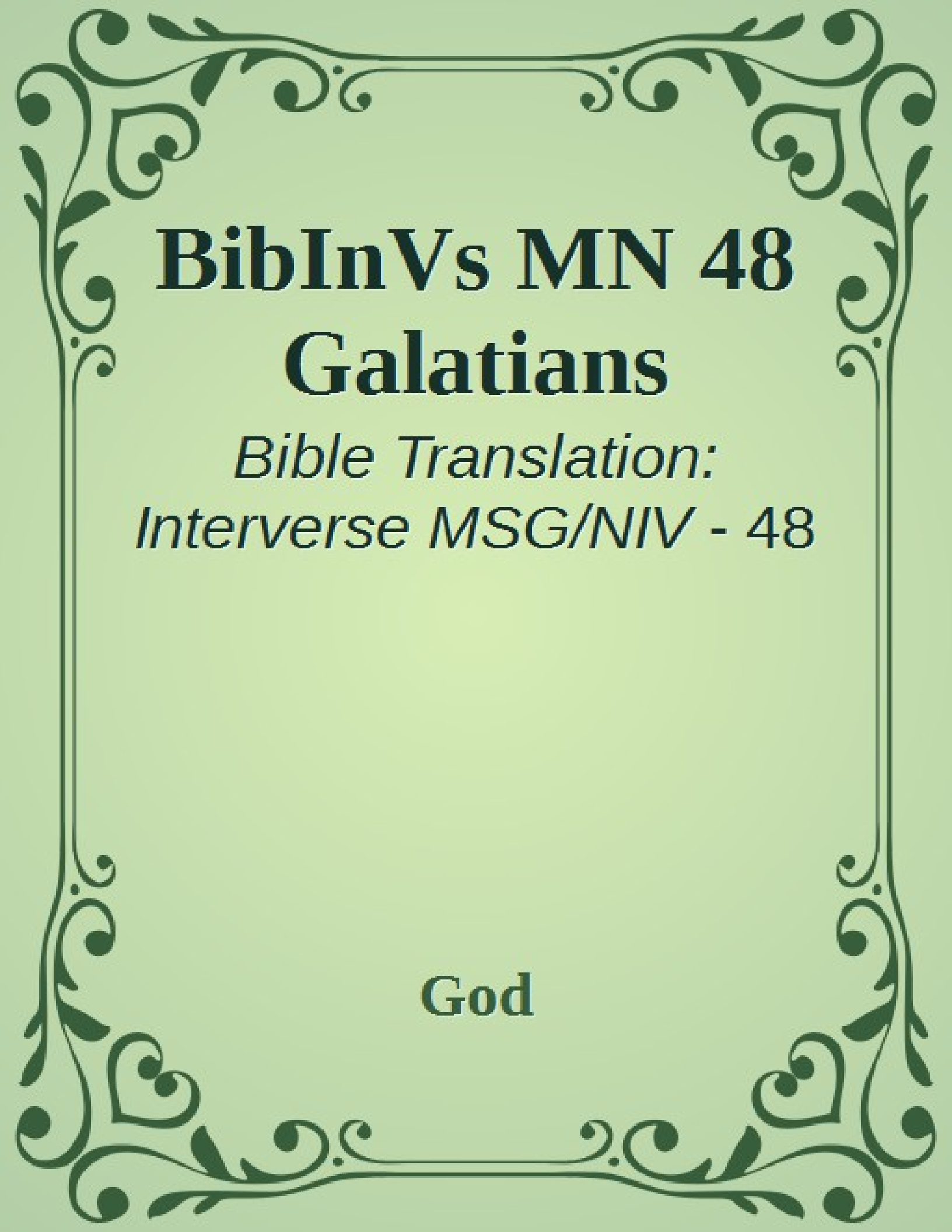


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 48

Galatians

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 48*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Galatians

Galatians 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 I, Paul, and my companions in faith here, send greetings to the Galatian churches. My authority for writing to you does not come from any popular vote of the people, nor does it come through the appointment of some human higher-up. It comes directly from Jesus the Messiah and God the Father, who raised him from the dead. I'm God-commissioned.
- 1 Paul, an apostle--sent not from men nor by man, but by Jesus Christ and God the Father, who raised him from the dead--
- 2 (SEE 1:1)
- 2 and all the brothers with me, To the churches in Galatia:
- 3 So I greet you with the great words, grace and peace!
- 3 Grace and peace to you from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ,
- 4 We know the meaning of those words because Jesus Christ rescued us from this evil world we're in by offering himself as a sacrifice for our sins. God's plan is that we all experience that rescue.
- 4 who gave himself for our sins to rescue us from the present evil age, according to the will of our God and Father,
- 5 Glory to God forever! Oh, yes!
- 5 to whom be glory for ever and ever. Amen.
- 6 I can't believe your fickleness--how easily you have turned traitor to him who called you by the grace of Christ by embracing a variant message!
- 6 I am astonished that you are so quickly deserting the one who called you by the grace of Christ and are turning to a different gospel--
- 7 It is not a minor variation, you know; it is completely other, an alien message, a no-message, a lie about God. Those who are provoking this agitation among you are turning the Message of Christ on its head.
- 7 which is really no gospel at all. Evidently some people are throwing you into confusion and are trying to pervert the gospel of Christ.

- 8 Let me be blunt: If one of us--even if an angel from heaven!--were to preach something other than what we preached originally, let him be cursed.
- 8 But even if we or an angel from heaven should preach a gospel other than the one we preached to you, let him be eternally condemned!
- 9 I said it once; I'll say it again: If anyone, regardless of reputation or credentials, preaches something other than what you received originally, let him be cursed.
- 9 As we have already said, so now I say again: If anybody is preaching to you a gospel other than what you accepted, let him be eternally condemned!
- 10 Do you think I speak this strongly in order to manipulate crowds? Or curry favor with God? Or get popular applause? If my goal was popularity, I wouldn't bother being Christ's slave.
- 10 Am I now trying to win the approval of men, or of God? Or am I trying to please men? If I were still trying to please men, I would not be a servant of Christ.
- 11 Know this--I am most emphatic here, friends--this great Message I delivered to you is not mere human optimism.
- 11 I want you to know, brothers, that the gospel I preached is not something that man made up.
- 12 I didn't receive it through the traditions, and I wasn't taught it in some school. I got it straight from God, received the Message directly from Jesus Christ.
- 12 I did not receive it from any man, nor was I taught it; rather, I received it by revelation from Jesus Christ.
- 13 I'm sure that you've heard the story of my earlier life when I lived in the Jewish way. In those days I went all out in persecuting God's church. I was systematically destroying it.
- 13 For you have heard of my previous way of life in Judaism, how intensely I persecuted the church of God and tried to destroy it.
- 14 I was so enthusiastic about the traditions of my ancestors that I advanced head and shoulders above my peers in my career.
- 14 I was advancing in Judaism beyond many Jews of my own age and was extremely zealous for the traditions of my fathers.

15 Even then God had designs on me. Why, when I was still in my mother's womb he chose and called me out of sheer generosity!

15 But when God, who set me apart from birth and called me by his grace, was pleased

16 Now he has intervened and revealed his Son to me so that I might joyfully tell non-Jews about him. Immediately after my calling--without consulting anyone around me

16 to reveal his Son in me so that I might preach him among the Gentiles, I did not consult any man,

17 and without going up to Jerusalem to confer with those who were apostles long before I was--I got away to Arabia. Later I returned to Damascus,

17 nor did I go up to Jerusalem to see those who were apostles before I was, but I went immediately into Arabia and later returned to Damascus.

18 but it was three years before I went up to Jerusalem to compare stories with Peter. I was there only fifteen days--but what days they were!

18 Then after three years, I went up to Jerusalem to get acquainted with Peter and stayed with him fifteen days.

19 Except for our Master's brother James, I saw no other apostles.

19 I saw none of the other apostles--only James, the Lord's brother.

20 (I'm telling you the absolute truth in this.)

20 I assure you before God that what I am writing you is no lie.

21 Then I began my ministry in the regions of Syria and Cilicia.

21 Later I went to Syria and Cilicia.

22 After all that time and activity I was still unknown by face among the Christian churches in Judea.

22 I was personally unknown to the churches of Judea that are in Christ.

23 There was only this report: "That man who once persecuted us is now preaching the very message he used to try to destroy."

23 They only heard the report: "The man who formerly persecuted us is now preaching the faith he once tried to destroy."

24 Their response was to recognize and worship God because of me!

24 And they praised God because of me.

Galatians 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 Fourteen years after that first visit, Barnabas and I went up to Jerusalem and took Titus with us.
- 1 Fourteen years later I went up again to Jerusalem, this time with Barnabas. I took Titus along also.
- 2 I went to clarify with them what had been revealed to me. At that time I placed before them exactly what I was preaching to the non-Jews. I did this in private with the leaders, those held in esteem by the church, so that our concern would not become a controversial public issue, marred by ethnic tensions, exposing my years of work to denigration and endangering my present ministry.
- 2 I went in response to a revelation and set before them the gospel that I preach among the Gentiles. But I did this privately to those who seemed to be leaders, for fear that I was running or had run my race in vain.
- 3 Significantly, Titus, non-Jewish though he was, was not required to be circumcised.
- 3 Yet not even Titus, who was with me, was compelled to be circumcised, even though he was a Greek.
- 4 While we were in conference we were infiltrated by spies pretending to be Christians, who slipped in to find out just how free true Christians are. Their ulterior motive was to reduce us to their brand of servitude.
- 4 This matter arose because some false brothers had infiltrated our ranks to spy on the freedom we have in Christ Jesus and to make us slaves.
- 5 We didn't give them the time of day. We were determined to preserve the truth of the Message for you.
- 5 We did not give in to them for a moment, so that the truth of the gospel might remain with you.
- 6 As for those who were considered important in the church, their reputation doesn't concern me. God isn't impressed with mere appearances, and neither am I. And of course these leaders were able to add nothing to the message I had been preaching.
- 6 As for those who seemed to be important--whatever they were makes no difference to me; God does not judge by external appearance--those men added nothing to my message.

- 7 It was soon evident that God had entrusted me with the same message to the non-Jews as Peter had been preaching to the Jews.
- 7 On the contrary, they saw that I had been entrusted with the task of preaching the gospel to the Gentiles, just as Peter had been to the Jews.
- 8 (SEE 2:7)
- 8 For God, who was at work in the ministry of Peter as an apostle to the Jews, was also at work in my ministry as an apostle to the Gentiles.
- 9 Recognizing that my calling had been given by God, James, Peter, and John--the pillars of the church--shook hands with me and Barnabas, assigning us to a ministry to the non-Jews, while they continued to be responsible for reaching out to the Jews.
- 9 James, Peter and John, those reputed to be pillars, gave me and Barnabas the right hand of fellowship when they recognized the grace given to me. They agreed that we should go to the Gentiles, and they to the Jews.
- 10 The only additional thing they asked was that we remember the poor, and I was already eager to do that.
- 10 All they asked was that we should continue to remember the poor, the very thing I was eager to do.
- 11 Later, when Peter came to Antioch, I had a face-to-face confrontation with him because he was clearly out of line.
- 11 When Peter came to Antioch, I opposed him to his face, because he was clearly in the wrong.
- 12 Here's the situation. Earlier, before certain persons had come from James, Peter regularly ate with the non-Jews. But when that conservative group came from Jerusalem, he cautiously pulled back and put as much distance as he could manage between himself and his non-Jewish friends. That's how fearful he was of the conservative Jewish clique that's been pushing the old system of circumcision.
- 12 Before certain men came from James, he used to eat with the Gentiles. But when they arrived, he began to draw back and separate himself from the Gentiles because he was afraid of those who belonged to the circumcision group.
- 13 Unfortunately, the rest of the Jews in the Antioch church joined in that hypocrisy so that even Barnabas was swept along in the charade.
- 13 The other Jews joined him in his hypocrisy, so that by their hypocrisy even Barnabas was led astray.

- 14 But when I saw that they were not maintaining a steady, straight course according to the Message, I spoke up to Peter in front of them all: "If you, a Jew, live like a non-Jew when you're not being observed by the watchdogs from Jerusalem, what right do you have to require non-Jews to conform to Jewish customs just to make a favorable impression on your old Jerusalem cronies?"
- 14 When I saw that they were not acting in line with the truth of the gospel, I said to Peter in front of them all, "You are a Jew, yet you live like a Gentile and not like a Jew. How is it, then, that you force Gentiles to follow Jewish customs?"
- 15 We Jews know that we have no advantage of birth over "non-Jewish sinners."
- 15 We who are Jews by birth and not 'Gentile sinners'
- 16 We know very well that we are not set right with God by rule-keeping but only through personal faith in Jesus Christ. How do we know? We tried it--and we had the best system of rules the world has ever seen! Convinced that no human being can please God by self-improvement, we believed in Jesus as the Messiah so that we might be set right before God by trusting in the Messiah, not by trying to be good.
- 16 know that a man is not justified by observing the law, but by faith in Jesus Christ. So we, too, have put our faith in Christ Jesus that we may be justified by faith in Christ and not by observing the law, because by observing the law no one will be justified.
- 17 Have some of you noticed that we are not yet perfect? (No great surprise, right?) And are you ready to make the accusation that since people like me, who go through Christ in order to get things right with God, aren't perfectly virtuous, Christ must therefore be an accessory to sin? The accusation is frivolous.
- 17 If, while we seek to be justified in Christ, it becomes evident that we ourselves are sinners, does that mean that Christ promotes sin? Absolutely not!
- 18 If I was "trying to be good," I would be rebuilding the same old barn that I tore down. I would be acting as a charlatan.
- 18 If I rebuild what I destroyed, I prove that I am a lawbreaker.
- 19 What actually took place is this: I tried keeping rules and working my head off to please God, and it didn't work. So I quit being a "law man" so

that I could be God's man.

19 For through the law I died to the law so that I might live for God.

20 Christ's life showed me how, and enabled me to do it. I identified myself completely with him. Indeed, I have been crucified with Christ. My ego is no longer central. It is no longer important that I appear righteous before you or have your good opinion, and I am no longer driven to impress God. Christ lives in me. The life you see me living is not "mine," but it is lived by faith in the Son of God, who loved me and gave himself for me.

20 I have been crucified with Christ and I no longer live, but Christ lives in me. The life I live in the body, I live by faith in the Son of God, who loved me and gave himself for me.

21 I am not going to go back on that. Is it not clear to you that to go back to that old rule-keeping, peer-pleasing religion would be an abandonment of everything personal and free in my relationship with God? I refuse to do that, to repudiate God's grace. If a living relationship with God could come by rule-keeping, then Christ died unnecessarily.

21 I do not set aside the grace of God, for if righteousness could be gained through the law, Christ died for nothing!"

Galatians 3

MSG

NIV

1 You crazy Galatians! Did someone put a hex on you? Have you taken leave of your senses? Something crazy has happened, for it's obvious that you no longer have the crucified Jesus in clear focus in your lives. His sacrifice on the Cross was certainly set before you clearly enough.

1 You foolish Galatians! Who has bewitched you? Before your very eyes Jesus Christ was clearly portrayed as crucified.

2 Let me put this question to you: How did your new life begin? Was it by working your heads off to please God? Or was it by responding to God's Message to you?

2 I would like to learn just one thing from you: Did you receive the Spirit by observing the law, or by believing what you heard?

- 3 Are you going to continue this craziness? For only crazy people would think they could complete by their own efforts what was begun by God. If you weren't smart enough or strong enough to begin it, how do you suppose you could perfect it?
- 3 Are you so foolish? After beginning with the Spirit, are you now trying to attain your goal by human effort?
- 4 Did you go through this whole painful learning process for nothing? It is not yet a total loss, but it certainly will be if you keep this up!
- 4 Have you suffered so much for nothing--if it really was for nothing?
- 5 Answer this question: Does the God who lavishly provides you with his own presence, his Holy Spirit, working things in your lives you could never do for yourselves, does he do these things because of your strenuous moral striving or because you trust him to do them in you?
- 5 Does God give you his Spirit and work miracles among you because you observe the law, or because you believe what you heard?
- 6 Don't these things happen among you just as they happened with Abraham? He believed God, and that act of belief was turned into a life that was right with God.
- 6 Consider Abraham: "He believed God, and it was credited to him as righteousness."
- 7 Is it not obvious to you that persons who put their trust in Christ (not persons who put their trust in the law!) are like Abraham: children of faith?
- 7 Understand, then, that those who believe are children of Abraham.
- 8 It was all laid out beforehand in Scripture that God would set things right with non-Jews by faith. Scripture anticipated this in the promise to Abraham: "All nations will be blessed in you."
- 8 The Scripture foresaw that God would justify the Gentiles by faith, and announced the gospel in advance to Abraham: "All nations will be blessed through you."
- 9 So those now who live by faith are blessed along with Abraham, who lived by faith--this is no new doctrine!
- 9 So those who have faith are blessed along with Abraham, the man of faith.
- 10 And that means that anyone who tries to live by his own effort, independent of God, is doomed to failure. Scripture backs this up:

- "Utterly cursed is every person who fails to carry out every detail written in the Book of the law."
- 10 All who rely on observing the law are under a curse, for it is written: "Cursed is everyone who does not continue to do everything written in the Book of the Law."
- 11 The obvious impossibility of carrying out such a moral program should make it plain that no one can sustain a relationship with God that way. The person who lives in right relationship with God does it by embracing what God arranges for him. Doing things for God is the opposite of entering into what God does for you. Habakkuk had it right: "The person who believes God, is set right by God--and that's the real life."
- 11 Clearly no one is justified before God by the law, because, "The righteous will live by faith."
- 12 Rule-keeping does not naturally evolve into living by faith, but only perpetuates itself in more and more rule-keeping, a fact observed in Scripture: "The one who does these things [rule-keeping] continues to live by them."
- 12 The law is not based on faith; on the contrary, "The man who does these things will live by them."
- 13 Christ redeemed us from that self-defeating, cursed life by absorbing it completely into himself. Do you remember the Scripture that says, "Cursed is everyone who hangs on a tree"? That is what happened when Jesus was nailed to the Cross: He became a curse, and at the same time dissolved the curse.
- 13 Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law by becoming a curse for us, for it is written: "Cursed is everyone who is hung on a tree."
- 14 And now, because of that, the air is cleared and we can see that Abraham's blessing is present and available for non-Jews, too. We are all able to receive God's life, his Spirit, in and with us by believing--just the way Abraham received it.
- 14 He redeemed us in order that the blessing given to Abraham might come to the Gentiles through Christ Jesus, so that by faith we might receive the promise of the Spirit.
- 15 Friends, let me give you an example from everyday affairs of the free life I am talking about. Once a person's will has been ratified, no one else can annul it or add to it.

- 15 Brothers, let me take an example from everyday life. Just as no one can set aside or add to a human covenant that has been duly established, so it is in this case.
- 16 Now, the promises were made to Abraham and to his descendant. You will observe that Scripture, in the careful language of a legal document, does not say "to descendants," referring to everybody in general, but "to your descendant" (the noun, note, is singular), referring to Christ.
- 16 The promises were spoken to Abraham and to his seed. The Scripture does not say "and to seeds," meaning many people, but "and to your seed," meaning one person, who is Christ.
- 17 This is the way I interpret this: A will, earlier ratified by God, is not annulled by an addendum attached 430 years later, thereby negating the promise of the will.
- 17 What I mean is this: The law, introduced 430 years later, does not set aside the covenant previously established by God and thus do away with the promise.
- 18 No, this addendum, with its instructions and regulations, has nothing to do with the promised inheritance in the will. What is the point, then, of the law, the attached addendum? It was a thoughtful addition to the original covenant promises made to Abraham.
- 18 For if the inheritance depends on the law, then it no longer depends on a promise; but God in his grace gave it to Abraham through a promise.
- 19 The purpose of the law was to keep a sinful people in the way of salvation until Christ (the descendant) came, inheriting the promises and distributing them to us. Obviously this law was not a firsthand encounter with God. It was arranged by angelic messengers through a middleman, Moses.
- 19 What, then, was the purpose of the law? It was added because of transgressions until the Seed to whom the promise referred had come. The law was put into effect through angels by a mediator.
- 20 But if there is a middleman as there was at Sinai, then the people are not dealing directly with God, are they? But the original promise is the direct blessing of God, received by faith.
- 20 A mediator, however, does not represent just one party; but God is one.
- 21 If such is the case, is the law, then, an anti-promise, a negation of God's will for us? Not at all. Its purpose was to make obvious to everyone that

we are, in ourselves, out of right relationship with God, and therefore to show us the futility of devising some religious system for getting by our own efforts what we can only get by waiting in faith for God to complete his promise. For if any kind of rule-keeping had power to create life in us, we would certainly have gotten it by this time.

21 Is the law, therefore, opposed to the promises of God? Absolutely not! For if a law had been given that could impart life, then righteousness would certainly have come by the law.

22 (SEE 3:21)

22 But the Scripture declares that the whole world is a prisoner of sin, so that what was promised, being given through faith in Jesus Christ, might be given to those who believe.

23 Until the time when we were mature enough to respond freely in faith to the living God, we were carefully surrounded and protected by the Mosaic law.

23 Before this faith came, we were held prisoners by the law, locked up until faith should be revealed.

24 The law was like those Greek tutors, with which you are familiar, who escort children to school and protect them from danger or distraction, making sure the children will really get to the place they set out for.

24 So the law was put in charge to lead us to Christ that we might be justified by faith.

25 But now you have arrived at your destination:

25 Now that faith has come, we are no longer under the supervision of the law.

26 By faith in Christ you are in direct relationship with God.

26 You are all sons of God through faith in Christ Jesus,

27 Your baptism in Christ was not just washing you up for a fresh start. It also involved dressing you in an adult faith wardrobe--Christ's life, the fulfillment of God's original promise.

27 for all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ.

28 In Christ's family there can be no division into Jew and non-Jew, slave and free, male and female. Among us you are all equal. That is, we are all in a common relationship with Jesus Christ.

28 There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus.

29 Also, since you are Christ's family, then you are Abraham's famous "descendant," heirs according to the covenant promises.

29 If you belong to Christ, then you are Abraham's seed, and heirs according to the promise.

Galatians 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Let me show you the implications of this. As long as the heir is a minor, he has no advantage over the slave. Though legally he owns the entire inheritance,
- 1 What I am saying is that as long as the heir is a child, he is no different from a slave, although he owns the whole estate.
- 2 he is subject to tutors and administrators until whatever date the father has set for emancipation.
- 2 He is subject to guardians and trustees until the time set by his father.
- 3 That is the way it is with us: When we were minors, we were just like slaves ordered around by simple instructions (the tutors and administrators of this world), with no say in the conduct of our own lives.
- 3 So also, when we were children, we were in slavery under the basic principles of the world.
- 4 But when the time arrived that was set by God the Father, God sent his Son, born among us of a woman, born under the conditions of the law so that he might redeem those of us who have been kidnapped by the law.
- 4 But when the time had fully come, God sent his Son, born of a woman, born under law,
- 5 Thus we have been set free to experience our rightful heritage.
- 5 to redeem those under law, that we might receive the full rights of sons.
- 6 You can tell for sure that you are now fully adopted as his own children because God sent the Spirit of his Son into our lives crying out, "Papa! Father!"

- 6 Because you are sons, God sent the Spirit of his Son into our hearts, the Spirit who calls out, "Abba, Father."
- 7 Doesn't that privilege of intimate conversation with God make it plain that you are not a slave, but a child? And if you are a child, you're also an heir, with complete access to the inheritance.
- 7 So you are no longer a slave, but a son; and since you are a son, God has made you also an heir.
- 8 Earlier, before you knew God personally, you were enslaved to so-called gods that had nothing of the divine about them.
- 8 Formerly, when you did not know God, you were slaves to those who by nature are not gods.
- 9 But now that you know the real God--or rather since God knows you--how can you possibly subject yourselves again to those paper tigers?
- 9 But now that you know God--or rather are known by God--how is it that you are turning back to those weak and miserable principles? Do you wish to be enslaved by them all over again?
- 10 For that is exactly what you do when you are intimidated into scrupulously observing all the traditions, taboos, and superstitions associated with special days and seasons and years.
- 10 You are observing special days and months and seasons and years!
- 11 I am afraid that all my hard work among you has gone up in a puff of smoke!
- 11 I fear for you, that somehow I have wasted my efforts on you.
- 12 My dear friends, what I would really like you to do is try to put yourselves in my shoes to the same extent that I, when I was with you, put myself in yours. You were very sensitive and kind then. You did not come down on me personally.
- 12 I plead with you, brothers, become like me, for I became like you. You have done me no wrong.
- 13 You were well aware that the reason I ended up preaching to you was that I was physically broken, and so, prevented from continuing my journey, I was forced to stop with you. That is how I came to preach to you.
- 13 As you know, it was because of an illness that I first preached the gospel to you.

- 14 And don't you remember that even though taking in a sick guest was most troublesome for you, you chose to treat me as well as you would have treated an angel of God--as well as you would have treated Jesus himself if he had visited you?
- 14 Even though my illness was a trial to you, you did not treat me with contempt or scorn. Instead, you welcomed me as if I were an angel of God, as if I were Christ Jesus himself.
- 15 What has happened to the satisfaction you felt at that time? There were some of you then who, if possible, would have given your very eyes to me--that is how deeply you cared!
- 15 What has happened to all your joy? I can testify that, if you could have done so, you would have torn out your eyes and given them to me.
- 16 And now have I suddenly become your enemy simply by telling you the truth? I can't believe it.
- 16 Have I now become your enemy by telling you the truth?
- 17 Those heretical teachers go to great lengths to flatter you, but their motives are rotten. They want to shut you out of the free world of God's grace so that you will always depend on them for approval and direction, making them feel important.
- 17 Those people are zealous to win you over, but for no good. What they want is to alienate you from us, so that you may be zealous for them.
- 18 It is a good thing to be ardent in doing good, but not just when I am in your presence. Can't you continue the same concern for both my person and my message when I am away from you that you had when I was with you?
- 18 It is fine to be zealous, provided the purpose is good, and to be so always and not just when I am with you.
- 19 Do you know how I feel right now, and will feel until Christ's life becomes visible in your lives? Like a mother in the pain of childbirth.
- 19 My dear children, for whom I am again in the pains of childbirth until Christ is formed in you,
- 20 Oh, I keep wishing that I was with you. Then I wouldn't be reduced to this blunt, letter-writing language out of sheer frustration.
- 20 how I wish I could be with you now and change my tone, because I am perplexed about you!

- 21 Tell me now, you who have become so enamored with the law: Have you paid close attention to that law?
- 21 Tell me, you who want to be under the law, are you not aware of what the law says?
- 22 Abraham, remember, had two sons: one by the slave woman and one by the free woman.
- 22 For it is written that Abraham had two sons, one by the slave woman and the other by the free woman.
- 23 The son of the slave woman was born by human connivance; the son of the free woman was born by God's promise.
- 23 His son by the slave woman was born in the ordinary way; but his son by the free woman was born as the result of a promise.
- 24 This illustrates the very thing we are dealing with now. The two births represent two ways of being in relationship with God. One is from Mount Sinai in Arabia.
- 24 These things may be taken figuratively, for the women represent two covenants. One covenant is from Mount Sinai and bears children who are to be slaves: This is Hagar.
- 25 It corresponds with what is now going on in Jerusalem--a slave life, producing slaves as offspring. This is the way of Hagar.
- 25 Now Hagar stands for Mount Sinai in Arabia and corresponds to the present city of Jerusalem, because she is in slavery with her children.
- 26 In contrast to that, there is an invisible Jerusalem, a free Jerusalem, and she is our mother--this is the way of Sarah.
- 26 But the Jerusalem that is above is free, and she is our mother.
- 27 Remember what Isaiah wrote: Rejoice, barren woman who bears no children, shout and cry out, woman who has no birth pangs, Because the children of the barren woman now surpass the children of the chosen woman.
- 27 For it is written: "Be glad, O barren woman, who bears no children; break forth and cry aloud, you who have no labor pains; because more are the children of the desolate woman than of her who has a husband."
- 28 Isn't it clear, friends, that you, like Isaac, are children of promise?
- 28 Now you, brothers, like Isaac, are children of promise.
- 29 In the days of Hagar and Sarah, the child who came from faithless connivance (Ishmael) harassed the child who came--empowered by the

Spirit--from the faithful promise (Isaac). Isn't it clear that the harassment you are now experiencing from the Jerusalem heretics follows that old pattern?

- 29 At that time the son born in the ordinary way persecuted the son born by the power of the Spirit. It is the same now.
- 30 There is a Scripture that tells us what to do: "Expel the slave mother with her son, for the slave son will not inherit with the free son."
- 30 But what does the Scripture say? "Get rid of the slave woman and her son, for the slave woman's son will never share in the inheritance with the free woman's son."
- 31 Isn't that conclusive? We are not children of the slave woman, but of the free woman.
- 31 Therefore, brothers, we are not children of the slave woman, but of the free woman.

Galatians 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 Christ has set us free to live a free life. So take your stand! Never again let anyone put a harness of slavery on you.
- 1 It is for freedom that Christ has set us free. Stand firm, then, and do not let yourselves be burdened again by a yoke of slavery.
- 2 I am emphatic about this. The moment any one of you submits to circumcision or any other rule-keeping system, at that same moment Christ's hard-won gift of freedom is squandered.
- 2 Mark my words! I, Paul, tell you that if you let yourselves be circumcised, Christ will be of no value to you at all.
- 3 I repeat my warning: The person who accepts the ways of circumcision trades all the advantages of the free life in Christ for the obligations of the slave life of the law.
- 3 Again I declare to every man who lets himself be circumcised that he is obligated to obey the whole law.
- 4 I suspect you would never intend this, but this is what happens. When you attempt to live by your own religious plans and projects, you are cut off from Christ, you fall out of grace.

- 4 You who are trying to be justified by law have been alienated from Christ; you have fallen away from grace.
- 5 Meanwhile we expectantly wait for a satisfying relationship with the Spirit.
- 5 But by faith we eagerly await through the Spirit the righteousness for which we hope.
- 6 For in Christ, neither our most conscientious religion nor disregard of religion amounts to anything. What matters is something far more interior: faith expressed in love.
- 6 For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision nor uncircumcision has any value. The only thing that counts is faith expressing itself through love.
- 7 You were running superbly! Who cut in on you, deflecting you from the true course of obedience?
- 7 You were running a good race. Who cut in on you and kept you from obeying the truth?
- 8 This detour doesn't come from the One who called you into the race in the first place.
- 8 That kind of persuasion does not come from the one who calls you.
- 9 And please don't toss this off as insignificant. It only takes a minute amount of yeast, you know, to permeate an entire loaf of bread.
- 9 A little yeast works through the whole batch of dough.
- 10 Deep down, the Master has given me confidence that you will not defect. But the one who is upsetting you, whoever he is, will bear the divine judgment.
- 10 I am confident in the Lord that you will take no other view. The one who is throwing you into confusion will pay the penalty, whoever he may be.
- 11 As for the rumor that I continue to preach the ways of circumcision (as I did in those pre-Damascus Road days), that is absurd. Why would I still be persecuted, then? If I were preaching that old message, no one would be offended if I mentioned the Cross now and then--it would be so watered-down it wouldn't matter one way or the other.
- 11 Brothers, if I am still preaching circumcision, why am I still being persecuted? In that case the offense of the cross has been abolished.
- 12 Why don't these agitators, obsessive as they are about circumcision, go all the way and castrate themselves!

- 12 As for those agitators, I wish they would go the whole way and emasculate themselves!
- 13 It is absolutely clear that God has called you to a free life. Just make sure that you don't use this freedom as an excuse to do whatever you want to do and destroy your freedom. Rather, use your freedom to serve one another in love; that's how freedom grows.
- 13 You, my brothers, were called to be free. But do not use your freedom to indulge the sinful nature; rather, serve one another in love.
- 14 For everything we know about God's Word is summed up in a single sentence: Love others as you love yourself. That's an act of true freedom.
- 14 The entire law is summed up in a single command: "Love your neighbor as yourself."
- 15 If you bite and ravage each other, watch out--in no time at all you will be annihilating each other, and where will your precious freedom be then?
- 15 If you keep on biting and devouring each other, watch out or you will be destroyed by each other.
- 16 My counsel is this: Live freely, animated and motivated by God's Spirit. Then you won't feed the compulsions of selfishness.
- 16 So I say, live by the Spirit, and you will not gratify the desires of the sinful nature.
- 17 For there is a root of sinful self-interest in us that is at odds with a free spirit, just as the free spirit is incompatible with selfishness. These two ways of life are antithetical, so that you cannot live at times one way and at times another way according to how you feel on any given day.
- 17 For the sinful nature desires what is contrary to the Spirit, and the Spirit what is contrary to the sinful nature. They are in conflict with each other, so that you do not do what you want.
- 18 Why don't you choose to be led by the Spirit and so escape the erratic compulsions of a law-dominated existence?
- 18 But if you are led by the Spirit, you are not under law.
- 19 It is obvious what kind of life develops out of trying to get your own way all the time: repetitive, loveless, cheap sex; a stinking accumulation of mental and emotional garbage; frenzied and joyless grabs for happiness;

- 19 The acts of the sinful nature are obvious: sexual immorality, impurity and debauchery;
- 20 trinket gods; magic-show religion; paranoid loneliness; cutthroat competition; all-consuming-yet-never-satisfied wants; a brutal temper; an impotence to love or be loved; divided homes and divided lives; small-minded and lopsided pursuits;
- 20 idolatry and witchcraft; hatred, discord, jealousy, fits of rage, selfish ambition, dissensions, factions
- 21 the vicious habit of depersonalizing everyone into a rival; uncontrolled and uncontrollable addictions; ugly parodies of community. I could go on. This isn't the first time I have warned you, you know. If you use your freedom this way, you will not inherit God's kingdom.
- 21 and envy; drunkenness, orgies, and the like. I warn you, as I did before, that those who live like this will not inherit the kingdom of God.
- 22 But what happens when we live God's way? He brings gifts into our lives, much the same way that fruit appears in an orchard--things like affection for others, exuberance about life, serenity. We develop a willingness to stick with things, a sense of compassion in the heart, and a conviction that a basic holiness permeates things and people. We find ourselves involved in loyal commitments,
- 22 But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness,
- 23 not needing to force our way in life, able to marshal and direct our energies wisely. Legalism is helpless in bringing this about; it only gets in the way.
- 23 gentleness and self- control. Against such things there is no law.
- 24 Among those who belong to Christ, everything connected with getting our own way and mindlessly responding to what everyone else calls necessities is killed off for good--crucified.
- 24 Those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the sinful nature with its passions and desires.
- 25 Since this is the kind of life we have chosen, the life of the Spirit, let us make sure that we do not just hold it as an idea in our heads or a sentiment in our hearts, but work out its implications in every detail of our lives.
- 25 Since we live by the Spirit, let us keep in step with the Spirit.

26 That means we will not compare ourselves with each other as if one of us were better and another worse. We have far more interesting things to do with our lives. Each of us is an original.

26 Let us not become conceited, provoking and envying each other.

Galatians 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 Live creatively, friends. If someone falls into sin, forgivingly restore him, saving your critical comments for yourself. You might be needing forgiveness before the day's out.
- 1 Brothers, if someone is caught in a sin, you who are spiritual should restore him gently. But watch yourself, or you also may be tempted.
- 2 Stoop down and reach out to those who are oppressed. Share their burdens, and so complete Christ's law.
- 2 Carry each other's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.
- 3 If you think you are too good for that, you are badly deceived.
- 3 If anyone thinks he is something when he is nothing, he deceives himself.
- 4 Make a careful exploration of who you are and the work you have been given, and then sink yourself into that. Don't be impressed with yourself. Don't compare yourself with others.
- 4 Each one should test his own actions. Then he can take pride in himself, without comparing himself to somebody else,
- 5 Each of you must take responsibility for doing the creative best you can with your own life.
- 5 for each one should carry his own load.
- 6 Be very sure now, you who have been trained to a self-sufficient maturity, that you enter into a generous common life with those who have trained you, sharing all the good things that you have and experience.
- 6 Anyone who receives instruction in the word must share all good things with his instructor.
- 7 Don't be misled: No one makes a fool of God. What a person plants, he will harvest. The person who plants selfishness, ignoring the needs of

others--ignoring God!--

- 7 Do not be deceived: God cannot be mocked. A man reaps what he sows.
- 8 harvests a crop of weeds. All he'll have to show for his life is weeds! But the one who plants in response to God, letting God's Spirit do the growth work in him, harvests a crop of real life, eternal life.
- 8 The one who sows to please his sinful nature, from that nature will reap destruction; the one who sows to please the Spirit, from the Spirit will reap eternal life.
- 9 So let's not allow ourselves to get fatigued doing good. At the right time we will harvest a good crop if we don't give up, or quit.
- 9 Let us not become weary in doing good, for at the proper time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up.
- 10 Right now, therefore, every time we get the chance, let us work for the benefit of all, starting with the people closest to us in the community of faith.
- 10 Therefore, as we have opportunity, let us do good to all people, especially to those who belong to the family of believers.
- 11 Now, in these last sentences, I want to emphasize in the bold scrawls of my personal handwriting the immense importance of what I have written to you.
- 11 See what large letters I use as I write to you with my own hand!
- 12 These people who are attempting to force the ways of circumcision on you have only one motive: They want an easy way to look good before others, lacking the courage to live by a faith that shares Christ's suffering and death. All their talk about the law is gas.
- 12 Those who want to make a good impression outwardly are trying to compel you to be circumcised. The only reason they do this is to avoid being persecuted for the cross of Christ.
- 13 They themselves don't keep the law! And they are highly selective in the laws they do observe. They only want you to be circumcised so they can boast of their success in recruiting you to their side. That is contemptible!
- 13 Not even those who are circumcised obey the law, yet they want you to be circumcised that they may boast about your flesh.
- 14 For my part, I am going to boast about nothing but the Cross of our Master, Jesus Christ. Because of that Cross, I have been crucified in

relation to the world, set free from the stifling atmosphere of pleasing others and fitting into the little patterns that they dictate.

14 May I never boast except in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, through which the world has been crucified to me, and I to the world.

15 Can't you see the central issue in all this? It is not what you and I do--submit to circumcision, reject circumcision. It is what God is doing, and he is creating something totally new, a free life!

15 Neither circumcision nor uncircumcision means anything; what counts is a new creation.

16 All who walk by this standard are the true Israel of God--his chosen people. Peace and mercy on them!

16 Peace and mercy to all who follow this rule, even to the Israel of God.

17 Quite frankly, I don't want to be bothered anymore by these disputes. I have far more important things to do--the serious living of this faith. I bear in my body scars from my service to Jesus.

17 Finally, let no one cause me trouble, for I bear on my body the marks of Jesus.

18 May what our Master Jesus Christ gives freely be deeply and personally yours, my friends. Oh, yes!

18 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit, brothers. Amen.